

3.8 Guidance on Centre Assessment

Introduction

The GCE Sciences share a common approach to centre assessment. This is based on the belief that assessment should encourage practical activity in science, and that practical activity should encompass a broad range of activities. This section must be read in conjunction with information in the Teaching and learning resources web pages.

Practical and Investigative Skills are assessed in the centre assessed units, Unit 3 and Unit 6 worth, respectively, 20% of the AS award (and 10% of the Advanced Level Award) and 10% of the full Advanced level award.

There are two routes for the assessment of Practical and Investigative Skills

Either

Route T: Practical Skills Assessment (PSA) + Investigative Skills Assignment (ISA) – Teacher-marked

Or

Route X: Practical Skills Verification (PSV) + Externally Marked Practical Assignment (EMPA) – AQA-marked.

Both routes to assessment are available at AS and A2.

Centres can not make entries for the same candidate for both assessment routes [T and X] in the same examination series.